EDUCATION NOTE / 2026 / SHOWCASE EDITION

Making field observations useful to public visitors

Geo-Kurdistan education group

Public geoscience | Kurdistan Region

Review status: Reviewed mock. This mock editorial publication supports teacher feedback on the showcase. It is not a published scientific study.

Abstract

An accessible model for translating field observations without removing the scientific context behind them.

01 / Observe before interpreting

A useful field note records what is visible before explaining why it formed. Colour, grain size, bed thickness, fracture orientation and spatial relationships can be described directly.

Interpretations should be added as a separate layer with an indication of confidence and the evidence still needed.



Observation before interpretation

Open-license image · source details in attribution file

02 / Translate without flattening the science

Public language can define technical terms in place rather than remove them. A short explanation beside the original geological term helps beginners while keeping the record useful to experienced visitors.

03 / Keep observations connected to place

Coordinates, locality names, viewing direction and access context allow a photograph to function as evidence rather than decoration. Sensitive or unsafe locations may require a generalized public position in a later production policy.



Water and exposed bedrock at Gali Ali Beg

Open-license image · source details in attribution file

04 / Make uncertainty productive

A pending-review label is an invitation to verify, not a weakness. The showcase uses these labels to identify exactly where teachers should correct terminology, add sources or revise an interpretation.

References and editorial limits

Editorial note

Accessible field-writing example created for the Geo-Kurdistan showcase.